Chapter 5 Habitats and interactions

EXTRA WORKSHEET 1: Carnivores and the rest

SCIENCE UNDERSTANDING

Name:_____Class:_____Date: _____

1 Organisms can be classified according to what they eat. One classification is into three groups: carnivore; omnivore and herbivore. Write the term that matches the definition.

Definition	Term
Consumer that eats only plants.	
Consumer that eats only animals.	
Consumer that eats both plants and animals.	

2 Read the description and then **classify** each organism as a carnivore, an omnivore or a herbivore.

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	Description	Classification
a	**Bears** in Canada are often photographed catching fish as the fish try to jump up waterfalls on their way to breed upstream. Bears are also seen picking berries from low bushes. Campers have to place all their food and rubbish in sealed containers or bears will steal it from them.	
b	There are many different **goannas** and their diets vary. Their prey includes insects, snakes, smaller lizards, birds and birds' eggs. Some giant goannas will kill a young kangaroo or even attack a dog. Goannas are attracted by the smell of rotting meat and feed off the bodies of dead animals.	
c	**Desert hopping mice** live in very harsh environments with little rain. To survive they have to eat what is available to them and have a varied diet of seeds, leaves, shoots, roots and insects.	
d	The **common brushtail possum** has adapted to living in cities and suburbs. In its natural habitat a brushtail possum eats mainly leaves and flowers. A particular favourite is fresh gum tips. Possums occasionally eat insects, eggs and meat. In urban areas they hunt through open compost bins to see what they can find.	
e	**Dugongs** are large sea creatures that feed on sea-grass beds on the bottom of the ocean floor. They use their flippers to uproot the sea-grasses and then the dugongs chew and crush their food. If sea grasses are not available, dugongs will eat algae. Scientific studies have identified the remains of worms and shellfish in the waste produced by dugongs. Scientists are not sure if these are eaten accidentally with the sea grasses or if the dugongs eat them intentionally.	
f	The diet of **yellow-footed rock wallabies** is similar to most other wallabies. They eat grass, plants and shrubs, which they chew with flat teeth at the back of their jaw.	

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